LESSON 5

Jingle Bells

By James Lord Pierpont, published in 1857: a song for a winter sleigh ride.

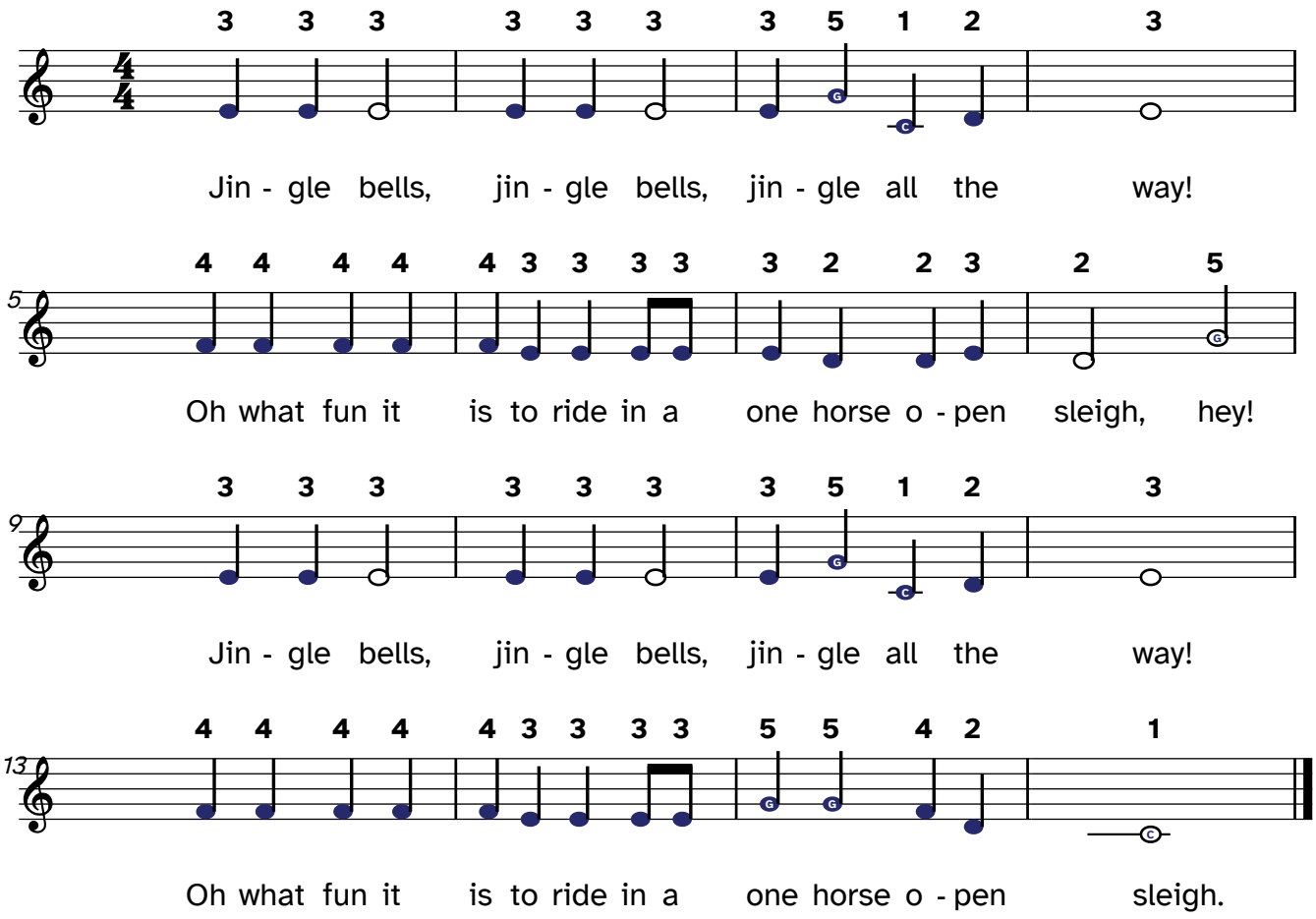
IN THIS SONG **the same note again** **long notes** **letters on C and G**

LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it with the words; keep the beat steady through the same notes.

Your hand: the C position, thumb on middle C. **Only C and G keep their letters now;** find the others from them.



THE WOW MOMENT
☆ **Sleigh ride with the band.** Scan the code and play the chorus with the band: the bells are real now. Then echo: your teacher plays *jin-gle bells*, you answer.

☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Sang it with the words**

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

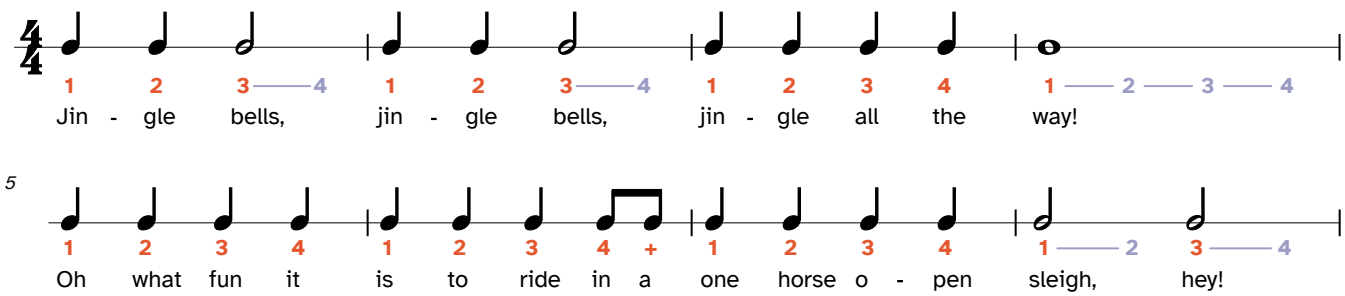
THE TIME

4/4

Top 4: four beats in every bar.
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

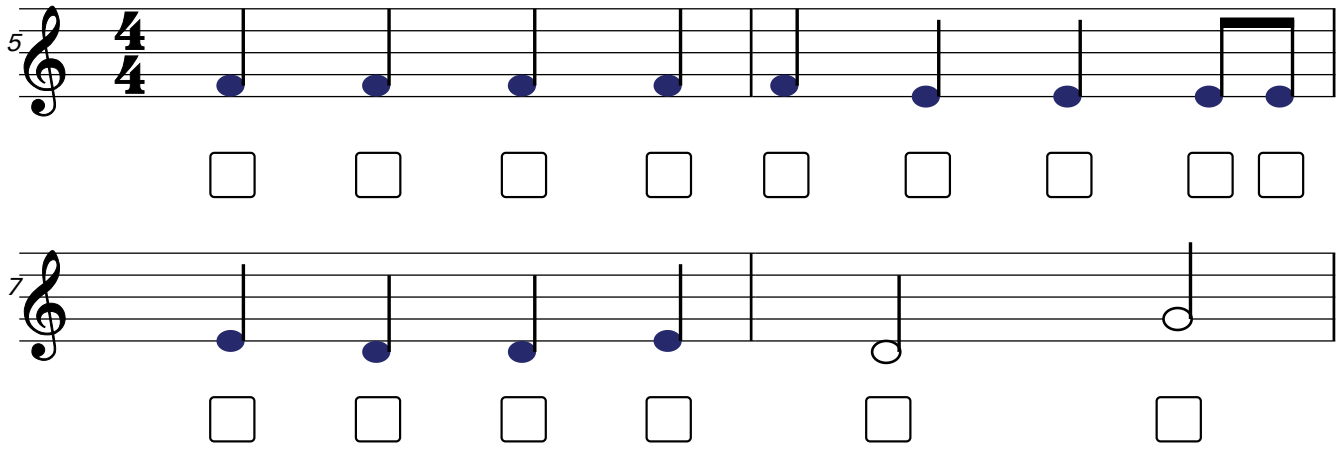
THE NOTES

- **crotchet: walk** — 1 beat ●
- **two quavers: run-ning** — 1 beat ◖◗
- **minim: hold** — 2 beats ●●
- **semibreve: hold-2-3-4** — 4 beats ●●●●



THE NOTES

Only C and G are named in the song now. Write the letter under each note of these bars.

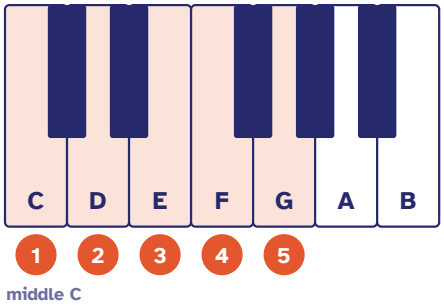


SPOT THE MISTAKE Your teacher plays the song with one wrong note. Put up your hand when you hear it, then find it on the page.

- ☐ **Said it in time**
- ☐ **Clapped and counted**
- ☐ **Wrote the letter names**
- ☐ **Spotted the mistake**

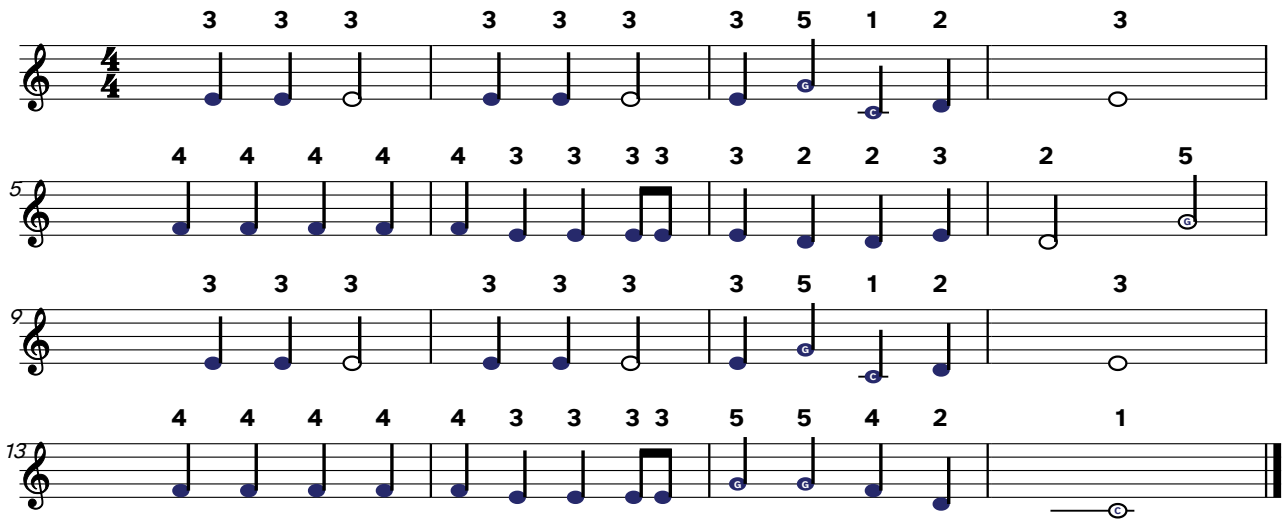
3 Play it

The right hand plays it all; the left hand plays line 1, an octave lower.

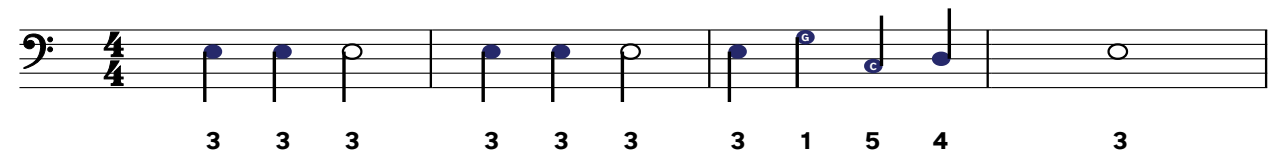


Right hand: thumb on middle C, 1 to 5 up to G. **Left hand:** an octave lower, on the King's staff: his sign's two dots wrap round F. Thumb on G, down to 5 on C.

R RIGHT HAND the whole song



L LEFT HAND line 1, the King's staff, an octave lower



4 · CHECK

☐ I can say and clap it ☐ I can sing it with the words ☐ I can find C and G and cou

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	With letters	No letters	With the band	Fast
Right hand				
Left hand				

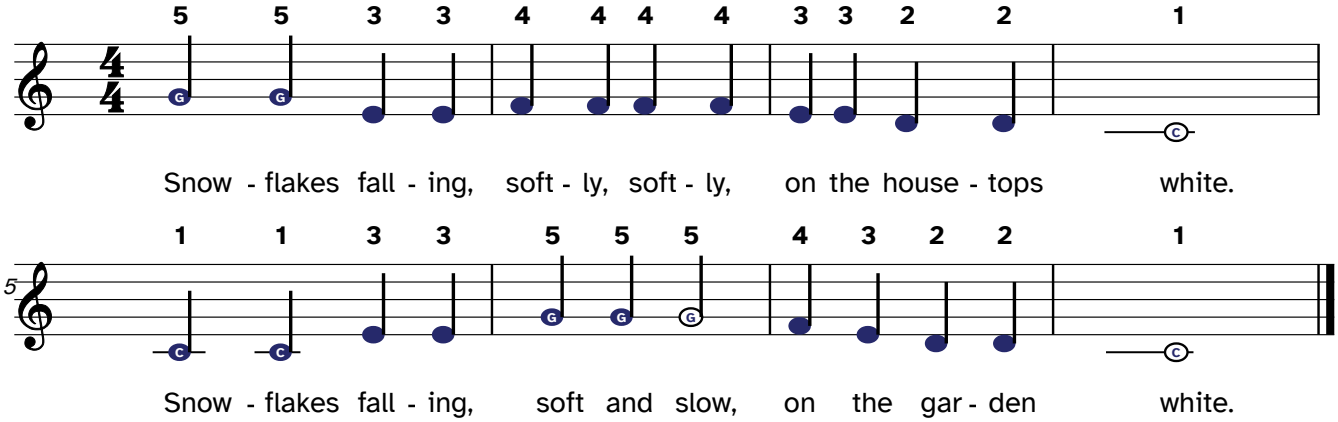
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

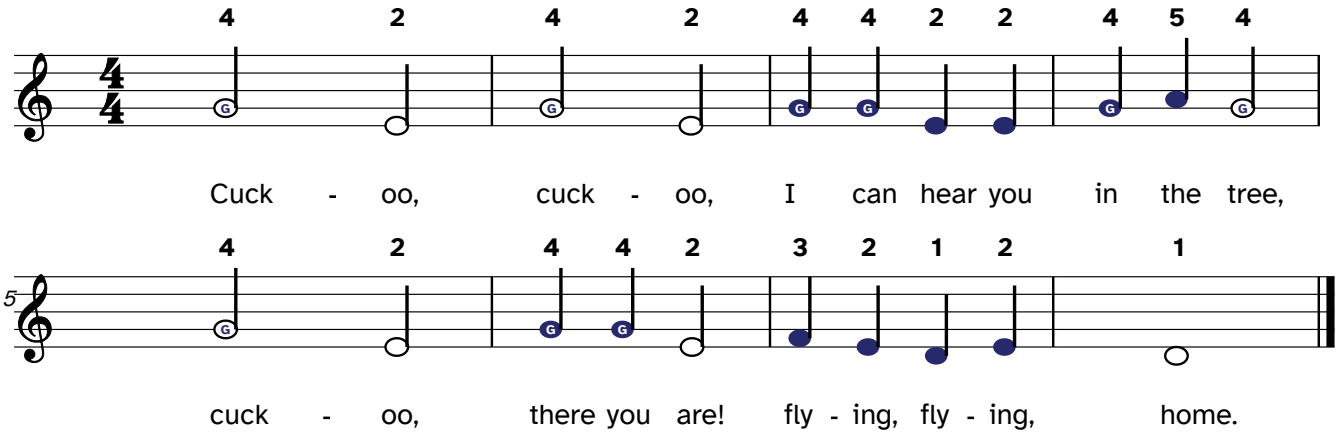
SNOWFLAKES

Soft and slow, like snow: notes that come again, and a long one to hold at the end of each line.



CUCKOO

A peek at Lesson 6: the cuckoo's call, G and E, with fingers 4 and 2. The hand sits one key higher, thumb on D, so finger 5 plays A.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Can your teacher guess which?

- ☐ **Galloping: quick and light, like the horse**
- ☐ **Heartbeat: the left hand taps low C on beat 1 of every bar**
- ☐ **Snowy: slow and soft, like falling snow**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Lines 1 and 2, twice
3. The whole song, twice
4. Play it with the band

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played the first tune** ☐ **Played the second tune**